



On the flip side, the hearing health tools are genuinely useful. The ability to personalise your sound profile through an in-app hearing test, or use the buds as mild hearing aids, is something no mainstream brand is doing this well. For older users or those with mild hearing issues, this could be a life-changing feature.

BATTERY & CONNECTIVITY

Battery life is one of the biggest upgrades. In testing, the AirPods Pro 3 lasted 8 hours with ANC on, nearly 3 hours longer than the AirPods Pro 2. That's a massive leap in daily convenience. Pop them in the case for a few minutes, and you'll get an hour of playback. Wireless charging, MagSafe, even Apple Watch charging, everything works seamlessly.

You can charge via USB-C, MagSafe, or even your Apple Watch puck. Wireless charging feels as seamless as you'd expect, though the missing USB-C cable in the box still feels stingy.

The AirPods Pro 3 still don't support any high-res codecs like LDAC or aptX. If you're using an Android phone, you're essentially getting basic SBC playback and no ANC controls, no firmware

updates, no EQ. It's like buying a Ferrari and only being allowed to drive it in first gear. Not fun, is it now?

EVERYDAY USE

Apple's polish shows up in the small details. You can now use the earbuds as a remote shutter for your iPhone's camera. The new Conversation Awareness mode automatically lowers your volume when you start speaking, which feels natural in practice. Personalized Volume also learns your environment and adjusts loudness accordingly, like turning itself down when you walk into a cafe, all of which works quite well.

The new case now features a built-in speaker and U2 Ultra Wideband chip, which means you can precisely locate it through the Find My app. It's one of those quality-of-life updates that you don't realise you needed until you misplace your earbuds under the couch.

VERDICT

The AirPods Pro 3 are the best earbuds Apple has ever made and arguably the best noise-cancelling earbuds most people can buy. They sound great, fit better, cancel noise like a dream, and integrate beautifully into the Apple ecosystem.

But they're also not perfect. The Live Translation feature is still half-baked, the heart rate sensor feels gimmicky for serious athletes, and the lack of EQ controls is baffling in 2025. Android users, as always, get the short end of the stick.

Still, for iPhone users, this is the most well-rounded, forward-thinking pair of earbuds Apple has ever shipped. You're getting near-flagship sound, class-leading ANC, smarter everyday features, and the kind of integration that makes everything feel effortless.

Rs 25,900 isn't cheap. But the comfort, consistency, and quiet brilliance they deliver make them worth it.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Chip: Apple H2 headphone chip | Sensors: Dual beamforming and inward facing microphones, Skin-detect sensor, motion-detecting and speech-detecting accelerometer, Heart rate sensor and touch control | Audio: Active Noise cancellation, Adaptive Audio, Conversation awareness, voice isolation, adaptive EQ | Battery: Up to 8 hrs of listening and up to 24 hours with Charging Case | IP Rating: IP57

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